Task Analysis Using AI Tools

Customize an Order and Add It to Cart

Domain: Online Food Delivery Mobile Application

1. User Task (For Reference)

Goal:

Select the exact item options, quantities, add-ons, and special instructions so the final order matches personal or dietary preferences.

Primary Actor:

A customer ordering for themselves or a group.

Trigger:

The user has selected a restaurant/menu and wants to configure specific items before ordering.

Preconditions:

A restaurant menu is open and at least one item is being configured.

Basic Flow:

1. Open an item and select size or variant.
2. Select modifiers (toppings, spice level, sides).
3. Add special instructions or allergy notes.
4. Set the desired quantity.
5. Add the item to the cart.
6. Repeat for additional items, then review the full cart.

Postcondition:

The cart contains correctly customized items ready for checkout.

2. Competitive Products for Reference (Shortcomings)

Product	Identified Shortcoming
Uber Eats	**Modifier menus nest many sub-options, requiring excessive scrolling and taps for a single item.**
Grubhub	**Special instructions are limited to free text with no structured allergy flags, risking miscommunication.**
DoorDash	**Selected modifiers can be silently dropped if the user backs out before confirming the item.**
Zomato	**Group ordering lacks a per-person item/cost breakdown inside the shared cart.**
Swiggy	**Combo/bundle items lock out individual swaps, forcing users to cancel and rebuild the entire combo.**

3. Human Factors and Environmental Considerations

- Cognitive: working-memory strain tracking multiple modifiers across several items, especially for group orders.
- Physical: repetitive small taps on toggles/checkboxes fatigue users during long customization chains.
- Environmental: ordering in noisy or distracting settings (office, family dinner) leads to rushed,

error-prone input.
- Emotional: anxiety about allergies or dietary needs not being clearly communicated to kitchen staff.
- Social: group ordering requires coordinating with others outside the app (texting screenshots), adding extra friction.

4. Pain Points, Challenges, and Tools Used by Users

Pain Points:

- Lost modifiers after navigating back in the app.
- Unclear price updates as modifiers are selected.
- No structured way to flag allergies or dietary restrictions.
- Inability to edit a single item within a combo/bundle.

Challenges:

- Designing a modifier UI that is flexible yet simple.
- Providing real-time price transparency as options change.
- Preventing accidental cart resets or dropped selections.

Tools Used by Users:

- In-app cart review screen.
- Screenshots and text messages to coordinate group orders.
- Notes app to record a 'usual order' for repeat use.
- Customer support chat to correct mistakes after submission.